

Budding gardener

Fill a child's watering can with a little water and help your baby hold onto the handle of the can. Keep your hand over hers to guide her and support the weight of the can as she tips water onto flowers in the garden. A raised flower bed is ideal, since she'll be able to hold onto the edge. If she's not yet standing, kneel down on the ground and let her sit on your lap to water the plants. She'll enjoy being your helper in this exciting new environment, and may even try to pull some weeds with you—all great practice for her manual dexterity.

